CARD 1 OF 8 SECURED **QUESTION**

A control valve is normally **open**. What are the three ways NFPA 25 allows it to be **secured**?

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CARD 2 OF 8 HOW OFTEN **QUESTION**

How often do control valves get **inspected**? Give the three frequencies and what earns each one.

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CARD 3 OF 8 WHAT YOU CHECK **QUESTION**

You're standing at the valve. Name **four things** the inspection has to confirm.

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CARD 4 OF 8 WHY A SEAL **QUESTION**

A plastic seal can be snapped by hand. **What's the point of it?**

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CARD 2 OF 8 HOW OFTEN **ANSWER**

Weekly: the starting point for every valve. A **sealed** valve stays here.
Monthly: valves secured with a **lock**.
Quarterly: valves that are **electrically supervised**.

The better the valve is secured, the longer it can go between inspections.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: "Weekly if it's unlocked." Weekly is for **sealed** valves. An unsecured valve isn't allowed at all.

CARD 1 OF 8 SECURED **ANSWER**

A seal, a lock, or electrical supervision. One of the three, every normally open valve.

Normally closed valves: a seal or electrical supervision.

Exempt: hose valves don't need a seal or supervision.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: an OS&Y with nothing on it. There's no "unsecured" option for a normally open control valve.

CARD 4 OF 8 WHY A SEAL **ANSWER**

It's a deterrent and a tattletale (Annex):
• It makes someone stop before closing a valve without the proper authority.
• A **broken or missing seal** tells the inspector the valve may have been moved. Check that protection isn't impaired and report it up.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Annex A (advisory)

On the job: broken seal on the weekly round? Don't just put a new one on. Confirm the valve is fully open first.

CARD 3 OF 8 WHAT YOU CHECK **ANSWER**

• In its **normal** position, open or closed.
• **Sealed, locked or supervised.**
• **Accessible.**
• PIVs have the **right wrench**.
• No **external leaks**.
• Has its **identification**: a sign saying what system or area it controls.

Annex on access: keep snow, ice and storage clear of it.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13 · Annex A

On the job: pallets stacked in front of the riser room OS&Y. Open and sealed, but it fails "accessible."

sheet 1 BACK — columns are intentionally mirrored for long-edge duplex · card numbers must match front to back

CARD 5 OF 8 ANNUAL OPERATION **QUESTION**

Besides looking at it, what does every control valve have to **do** once a year?

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CARD 6 OF 8 PIVS AND OS&YS **QUESTION**

You're opening a **PIV** back up. What are you feeling for, and where do you leave the handle?

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CARD 7 OF 8 WHEN IT'S CLOSED **QUESTION**

You need to **shut a control valve** to do some work. What has to happen?

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CARD 8 OF 8 TAMPER SWITCHES **QUESTION**

How often is a **valve supervisory (tamper) switch** tested, and **when** should it signal?

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CARD 6 OF 8 PIVS AND OS&YS **ANSWER**

PIV: open it until you feel **spring or torsion** in the rod. That tells you the rod is still connected to the valve. Do this **every time** the valve is closed.

PIV and OS&Y: once fully open, back off **a quarter turn** so the valve doesn't jam open.

Annex: use the proper wrench.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13 · Annex A

Trap: the target says OPEN but the rod spins free. If the rod's detached, the indicator lies.

CARD 5 OF 8 ANNUAL OPERATION **ANSWER**

Get operated through its full range, closed and opened, and put back in its **normal position**.

OS&Y valves: lubricate the stem every year, then close it all the way and reopen it to spread the grease and prove it works.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

Trap: a valve that hasn't moved in 10 years might not close when you need it to. Exercising it is how you find out on your schedule, not during an emergency.

CARD 8 OF 8 TAMPER SWITCHES **ANSWER**

Every 6 months (semiannually).

When it signals: within the **first two turns** of the handwheel, or once the stem has moved **one-fifth** of its travel from normal.

It clears only when the valve is back in its **normal** position. Nowhere else.

Inspection: quarterly, for physical damage.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13

On the job: the panel doesn't go into supervisory until the valve is half shut. That switch fails the test.

CARD 7 OF 8 WHEN IT'S CLOSED **ANSWER**

While it's shut: follow the **impairment procedures in Chapter 15**. The system is out of service.

When you reopen it at the riser: do a **valve status test**, flowing water to prove the valve really is open.

After the work: the owner or their representative confirms every valve is back in normal position and secured.

NFPA 25 (2020) · Ch. 13 · Ch. 3 · Ch. 15

Trap: "I turned it back on." Prove it with water.

sheet 2 BACK — columns are intentionally mirrored for long-edge duplex · card numbers must match front to back